Components of Blood

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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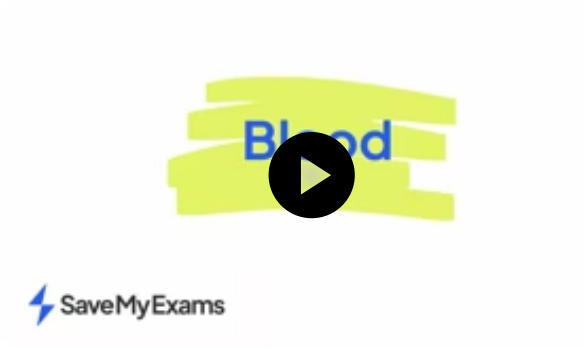

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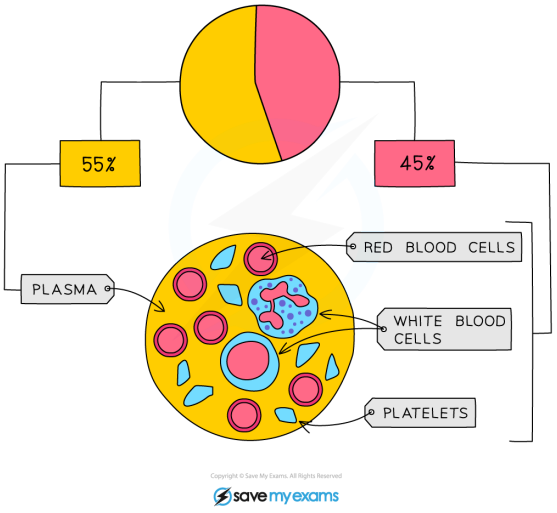
Help me understand

Components of Blood

- Blood consists of **red blood cells, white blood cells, platelets and plasma**



Composition of human blood

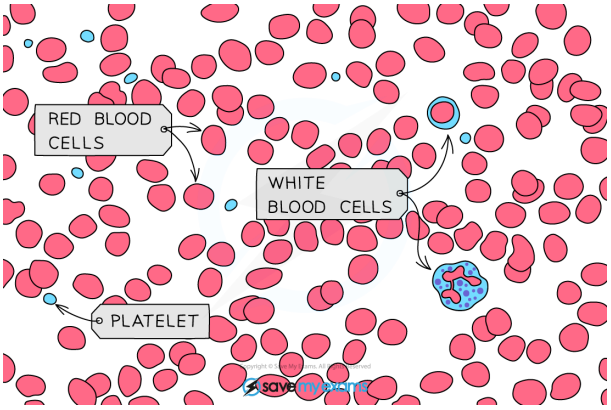
Components of the Blood Table

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

RED BLOOD CELLS	BICONCAVE DISCS CONTAINING NO NUCLEUS BUT PLENTY OF THE PROTEIN HAEMOGLOBIN
WHITE BLOOD CELLS	LARGE CELLS CONTAINING A BIG NUCLEUS, DIFFERENT TYPES HAVE SLIGHTLY DIFFERENT STRUCTURES AND FUNCTIONS
PLATELETS	FRAGMENTS OF CELLS
PLASMA	STRAW COLOURED LIQUID

Identifying Red & White Blood Cells

- You need to be able to identify red and white blood cells in photomicrographs and diagrams
  - Red blood cells have a concave disc shape with no nucleus
  - White blood cells are usually round in shape with a nucleus



Blood micrograph

Components of Blood: Function

- Plasma is important for the **transport** of carbon dioxide, digested food (nutrients), urea, mineral ions, hormones and heat energy
- Red blood cells **transport oxygen** around the body from the lungs to cells which require it for aerobic respiration
  - They carry the oxygen in the form of oxyhaemoglobin
- White blood cells **defend** the body against infection by pathogens by carrying out **phagocytosis** and **antibody production**

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